SAMUEL OGERA

Founder & CEO, MatXchange | Co-Founder & CEO, Dhow Partners

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SUMMARY

Founder and full-stack engineer building infrastructure for emerging markets. I lead MatXchange, which tracks waste from collection to recycler using IoT scales and the Stellar blockchain and pays informal collectors instantly through M-Pesa, and have raised USD 15,000 in non-dilutive funding. I also co-founded and lead Dhow Partners, an advisory and execution firm that helps companies and investors set up and grow in Kenya and East Africa, and previously co-founded GridFlow Solar as CTO.

VENTURES

Founder & CEO — MatXchange Nov 2024 – Present · Nairobi, Kenya

Digital infrastructure for Africa's waste supply chain: traceability at the point of collection and instant payment for informal collectors.

- Raised USD 15,000 in non-dilutive funding: USD 10,000 from the Stellar Community Fund (Instaward) and USD 5,000 seed capital from the Tony Elumelu Foundation (2025).
- Took the company from concept to a registered entity, supported by the Bridge for Billions incubator.
- Architected and built the platform on Frappe/ERPNext with IoT smart-scale weighing, Stellar blockchain records and M-Pesa micropayments.
- Secured a live pilot with a NEMA-licensed scrap-metal yard in Ongata Rongai; leading go-to-market and compliance frameworks.
- Opened partnership talks with the Waste Pickers Association of Kenya and the Kenya Association of Waste Recyclers.

Co-Founder & CEO — Dhow Partners 2026 – Present · Nairobi, Kenya

Advisory and execution firm that takes companies and investors from decision to result in Kenya and East Africa, through one point of contact and a network of vetted specialist firms.

- Co-founded the firm and wrote its operating model: seven service areas, from company setup and legal to hiring and market launch, run through one accountable client relationship.
- Built and launched dhowpartners.com, and represented the firm at the Africa Commerce & Industry Summit (ACIS) 2026.

Co-Founder & CTO — GridFlow Solar Mar 2025 – Jun 2026 · Nairobi, Kenya

Pay-as-you-go solar for off-grid schools and communities.

- Designed and built a full-stack PAYG solar wallet for buying, tracking and transferring solar credits, built offline-first for low-bandwidth rural use.
- Implemented IoT-linked payment tracking with Firebase Auth, Firestore and a mobile-responsive Tailwind UI.
- Co-led business development: pitch deck, financial model and go-to-market strategy. Selected for the Bridge for Billions incubator.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer — Gallant Branding International Apr 2026 – Aug 2026 · Nairobi, Kenya · Hybrid

- Built and launched the company websites for Gallant Group (gallant-group.com) and Gallant Branding International.
- Integrated payment APIs for automated payments and supported IoT smart-scale data transmission to cloud databases.
- Contributed to blockchain tokenization work in the Innovation and Technology department.

Community Manager & Ambassador — Stellar East Africa May 2025 – May 2026 · Hybrid

- Grew the regional Stellar developer community through workshops, mentorship events and project showcases.
- Onboarded new developers, moderated Discord and Telegram communities, and managed the community's LinkedIn presence.

Growth Intern — Zindua School May 2025 – Jul 2025 · Nairobi, Kenya

- Built Looker Studio dashboards tracking learner retention (75%) and graduate employability (60%).
- Designed a five-part impact framework combining learner data with stakeholder feedback; identified skill gaps that informed new curriculum workshops.
- Supported delivery of the GenAI Masterclass for Nairobi's tech community.

Consumer Insights & Strategy Extern — Beats by Dre Sep 2024 – Oct 2024 · Remote

- Turned interviews, surveys and competitor analysis into Gen Z engagement and rebranding recommendations with measurable KPIs.

EDUCATION

BA, Entrepreneurial Leadership — African Leadership University Sep 2024 – Jul 2028 · Kigali, Rwanda

- Coursework: Strategic Leadership, Design Thinking, Project Management, Data Analysis. Member, Frappe Club (ALU).

Software Engineering Bootcamp — Moringa School Feb 2024 – Aug 2024 · Nairobi, Kenya

- Full-stack development, team projects and agile delivery.

PROGRAMMES & RECOGNITION

- **Tony Elumelu Foundation Entrepreneurship Programme** (2025 cohort, seed funded); mentored by Tony Odeigah, MD & CEO, UBA Côte d'Ivoire
- **Bridge for Billions Incubator**

SKILLS

- **Engineering:** Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Frappe Framework, ERPNext, Django, React, Firebase, Tailwind, Stellar, M-Pesa and payment APIs, IoT integration
- **Business:** Company formation and governance, go-to-market strategy, financial modelling, market research, stakeholder and policy engagement
- **Leadership:** Team leadership, community building, public speaking, cross-cultural collaboration
- **Languages:** English (professional), Kiswahili (native)